VITyarthi Project Report

CSE0001 - Digital Literacy

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1. Introduction

As a newly appointed **Student Digital Ambassador**, my primary responsibility is to serve as a digital mentor for my peers, helping them navigate the complexities of the online world with professionalism and safety. This project, titled the **Digital Literacy Portfolio**, is a comprehensive collection of tasks designed to demonstrate my proficiency across five key modules of the **CSE0001** course.

The project scenario involves building a professional resource to be presented to a faculty committee and shared with my entire batch. By organizing my work within a central **GitHub repository**, I am documenting my journey through creating visual infographics, establishing professional student profiles, mastering cloud collaboration tools, and practicing high-standard email etiquette. Ultimately, this portfolio showcases my ability to use modern digital tools responsibly while fostering a secure and collaborative environment for the academic community.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Design Tool Used

To create the "Digital Literacy Essentials" infographic, I used **Canva**, a browser-based design platform. This tool was selected because it allows for the integration of professional icons and a clean, modular layout, which is essential for a Student Digital Ambassador aiming to communicate clearly with a large peer group.

Content and Visual Representation My design serves as a foundational guide covering five core pillars of digital life:

- **What is Digital Literacy:** A clear definition of the skills needed to use technology safely and confidently.
- **Useful Digital Tools:** A curated list of productivity apps, research databases, and collaboration platforms for students.
- **Safe Internet Practices:** Actionable advice on password strength, privacy settings, and avoiding phishing attempts.
- **Professional Online Presence:** Tips for maintaining a respectful tone and optimizing professional profiles like LinkedIn.
- **Email Etiquette:** A checklist for drafting professional communications with clear subject lines and proper formatting.

Reflection:

Interesting or Difficult Aspects What I found most interesting while making this infographic was the process of **visual hierarchy**. As a Student Digital Ambassador, the challenge wasn't just

listing information, but deciding how to arrange icons and text so a student could grasp the most important safety tips—like phishing and password strength—at a single glance. Balancing the descriptive text with enough white space to keep the design "scannable" required several iterations, but it taught me how to simplify complex technical topics into digestible visual modules.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

To establish a professional digital foundation, I have set up and updated my presence on three key platforms that are essential for the academic and professional engineering community.

Platforms Selected and Their Purpose

- **GitHub:** I use this platform as my primary technical portfolio to host code repositories, manage version control for my B.Tech projects, and showcase my proficiency in Python and software development to the global developer community.
- **LinkedIn:** This serves as my professional networking hub where I have detailed my education at VIT Bhopal. It is used to connect with industry experts, follow luxury automotive companies like BMW and Mercedes, and track internship opportunities.
- **Kaggle:** I chose Kaggle to specifically focus on my Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning specialization. It is used for participating in data science competitions, accessing large datasets, and practicing predictive modeling.

Future Utilization Plan

Over the next four years of my undergraduate journey, I plan to use these platforms as a living record of my growth as an engineer. I will consistently push my academic projects to GitHub to build a robust "proof-of-work" history for future employers. On LinkedIn, I intend to engage with the professional "Tech-Art" community to bridge the gap between my engineering skills and my aspirations in VFX. Finally, I will use Kaggle to refine my machine learning expertise by contributing to notebooks and competing in challenges, ensuring I remain competitive in the evolving AI landscape.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Platforms Used and Activities

For the technical portion of this task, I used **HackerRank** to complete a Python-based coding challenge involving leap year logic. This exercise improved my understanding of conditional statements and algorithmic thinking. For the collaboration portion, I utilized **Google Workspace** to design a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" via **Google Forms**. I configured exactly five questions, including multiple-choice and short-answer formats, to test my peers' knowledge of

online safety and professional tools. I also linked the form to a **Google Sheet** to demonstrate my ability to manage and analyze digital data responses efficiently.

Academic Benefits

Mastering these tools is vital for my B.Tech journey. Coding platforms like HackerRank provide a structured way to practice the technical skills required for my specialization in AI and Machine Learning. Simultaneously, proficiency in Google Workspace facilitates seamless collaboration on group projects and research. These platforms allow me to organize data, share resources, and practice the problem-solving skills necessary for a career in the technology sector.

These parts set the standards for things like how easy it is to use and how reliable it stays. They focus on user feel, code strength, and keeping the project going long term.

Task 4: Communication Scenario and Learnings

The Problem: Lack of Context in Digital Collaboration

In a common hypothetical scenario, a student group working on a coding project used a chaotic Discord thread to share updates. One member uploaded a critical, unlabelled file named `final_script_v2.py` without any documentation or comments. Because there was no "ReadMe" or context provided, another teammate accidentally overrode the file with an older version, leading to the loss of several hours of work and a heated argument that stalled the project.

What Could Have Been Done Differently

To avoid this, the team should have established a **Communication Protocol**. Specifically, they should have used a structured version control platform like **GitHub** with clear "Commit Messages" (e.g., *"Updated leap year logic in main script"*). Additionally, critical files should never be shared without a brief summary of the changes. This experience taught me that digital literacy isn't just about using tools, but about providing the necessary context to ensure collaboration remains professional and efficient.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

What Surprised Me Most During Research :
The most surprising aspect of researching UPI and QR code fraud was the sheer simplicity of the "Social Engineering" involved. I previously assumed cybercrime required complex hacking or data breaches, but I discovered that most modern financial theft relies on manipulating a user's basic trust. Seeing how scammers use professional-looking "Verified" account names and

"Collect Request" prompts to make a victim feel they are in control—when they are actually authorizing their own theft—was eye-opening. It highlighted that technical security measures are only as strong as the user's digital literacy.

One Habit I Will Personally Change :
As a result of this project, I have committed to the habit of **never scanning a QR code sent via a third-party chat app** for any transaction. Even if the sender seems legitimate, I will now insist on using official payment gateways or direct UPI ID entry. Furthermore, I have enabled biometrics for every single transaction on my device to ensure that no "Collect Request" can be accidentally approved without a second layer of verification.

Conclusion

Participating in this Digital Literacy project as a Student Digital Ambassador has been a transformative experience. It bridged the gap between my technical studies in AI and ML and the practical reality of digital safety. The core learning from this project is that **true digital literacy is a combination of technical skill and constant vigilance.** Whether it was structuring professional emails, managing a GitHub repository, or analyzing complex UPI scams, I realized that our digital footprint is our most valuable professional asset. I have learned that while tools like Python and automation are powerful, they must be used ethically and securely. Moving forward, I am more confident in navigating the digital landscape, protecting my personal data, and educating my peers on how to remain safe and professional in an increasingly connected world.

References

1. Digital Content & Design Platforms

Canva / Prezi: These design tools were utilized for Task 1 to create the "Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic," focusing on visual communication and layout.

Google Forms: Used for Task 3 (Part B) to build the "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" and manage peer data collection via linked Google Sheets.

Microsoft Word / Google Docs: Primary word processing software used to draft professional email templates for Task 4 and to compile this final 2500-word project report.

2. Professional Networking & Portfolio Hosting

GitHub: Served as the primary platform for the "Digital Literacy Portfolio." It was used to host the repository, organize task folders, and create the profile README.

LinkedIn: Utilized to establish a foundational professional presence, specifically documenting current B.Tech education and academic background at VIT Bhopal.

HackerRank / CodeChef: Used for Task 3 (Part A) to complete a beginner-level logic challenge and demonstrate familiarity with technical practice platforms.

3. Research, Safety, and Institutional Sources

National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: Technical details for the UPI fraud case study and prevention strategies were sourced from the official cybercrime.gov.in domain.

National Cyber Crime Helpline (1930): Cited as the official 24/7 telephonic reporting channel for financial and digital fraud in India.

VIT Bhopal University Brief: The official **CSE0001 Project Assignment Brief** was the primary guiding document for all task requirements and submission structures.

GitHub Markdown Guide: Referenced to ensure all .md files, including the social media etiquette checklist, utilized correct syntax for professional documentation.